INDIA'S VANI

CLIMATE CHANGE, DEFORESTATION, DISEASE AND HUMAN APATHY ARE TAKING A TOLL ON OUR AVIAN HERITAGE. IF WE DON'T ACT NOW, WE WILL LOSE SOME BIRDS FOREVER

By **SONALI ACHARJEE**



HIGH

LESSER FLORICAN

Sypheotides indicus

Habitat: Grasslands in Gujarat, Rajasthan and Maharashtra

Reason for decline: Invasive species in open habitats, collisions with power lines



SHUTTERSTOCK

HIGH

WHITE-BELLIED HERON

Ardea insignis

Habitat: Wetlands of tropical/ sub-tropical forests in the foothills of the eastern Himalayas of northeast India

Reason for decline: Loss of breeding and feeding grounds



HIGH

SLENDER-BILLED VULTURE

Gyps tenuirostris

Habitat: from the Gangetic plain north, west to Himachal, south as far as northern Odisha, and east through Assam

Reason for decline: Toxins found in carcasses they eat

SHUTTERSTOCK



HIGH

GREAT INDIAN BUSTARD

Ardeotis nigriceps

Habitat: Flat open landscapes in Rajasthan and Gujarat

Reason for decline: Loss and degradation of habitat, hunting

MANIPUR BUSH QUAIL

Perdicula manipurensis

Habitat: Damp grasslands of northeast India

Reason for decline: Drainage and destruction of tall grasslands; illegal trade



HIGH